> The absolute Swaraj is to be arrived at by means of the boycott and abstention from all recourse to the authorities, Swaraj through boycott is the burden of the speeches and the Swaraj aimed at clearly involves the departure of all foreigners from India.

Thus far, despite its negative tone, the judgment cannot be faulted as misrepresenting VOC's message. But in adducing motives, the judges were surely in the wrong.

> It may be that Chidambaram Pillai's own object was to some extent commercial; he was interested to a great extent in the *Swadeshi* Steam Navigation Company and other industrial enterprises and he may have discovered by the 19th February 1908 that ordinary commercial competition was not likely to be effectual against such powerful and long-established rivals as the British India Steam Navigation Company and the Coral Mills, and that his best chance of success was to secure the adhesion of his countrymen to his concerns by appeals to patriotic motives.

And therefore, the learned judges averred, VOC made the speeches that amounted to sedition. The judges then proceeded to give a full narrative of the events—the rousing political speeches in Tuticorin and the Coral Mills strike—in Tuticorin in February and March 1908. The speeches were so suffused with anti-British sentiment that the judges held that it was unlikely that the average man on the street made any distinction between official and unofficial British. From here, the judgment gave a full translation of the exchange between VOC and Wynch before the former's arrest—as depicted in Bharati's poem—and drew the following conclusion: 'The murder of Mr Ashe was a direct consequence of *this bitter hostility*.'

Following this, the judge quoted the evidence given by Somasundaram Pillai, an approver in the case, about his conversation with Vanchi when he met him at Ottapidaram.

> Question: What did he [Vanchi] say about [Swadeshi] Steam Navigation Company, Chidambara Pillai and Subramania Siva.
>
> Somasundaram Pillai: Steam Navigation Company Chidambaram worked for everything. The white men have ruined that, saying that the Indians should not conduct the Steam Navigation Company. The two persons who have lectured have been sent to jail.
>
> Question: Yes, anything else?